

VARUN PAREKH

CUSTOMER SUCCESS | ACCOUNT MANAGEMENT | RETENTION & EXPANSION

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Customer success and account-management professional with 7+ years of customer-facing experience across high-volume portfolio ownership, retention, expansion, and operational execution. Managed approximately 138 customer accounts representing a ~\$4M book of business, improved gross dollar retention from 72% to 86%, and drove approximately 26% expansion in spend among retained customers. Combines commercial judgment with a data-driven operator mindset, hands-on analytics, and AI/automation fluency to identify risk, improve adoption, build repeatable playbooks, and translate complex financial and technology concepts into clear actions.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

KIFS Trading - Part-Time Financial Trader (Remote) | Aug 2022 - Aug 2024

- Analyzed market and portfolio data through structured research and trend analysis, improving decision-making efficiency by approximately 15% and translating complex financial concepts into concise, client-facing recommendations.
- Built repeatable research and reporting workflows to surface decision-relevant insights quickly and support high-quality decisions in a fast-moving, high-pressure environment.

Kala Niketan - The Original - Senior Business Development Manager | Jun 2017 - May 2023

India | Dubai, UAE | Bahrain | Saudi Arabia

- Managed approximately 138 customer accounts representing a ~\$4M book of business; improved gross dollar retention from 72% to 86% and drove approximately 26% expansion in spend among retained customers through proactive risk identification, structured follow-up, issue resolution, and account growth.
- Exceeded a \$1M annual sales target with approximately \$2.8M in sales, including ~\$800K from cold-call-originated orders, demonstrating high-velocity outreach, commercial ownership, and disciplined follow-through.
- Led and trained 8 associates and built repeatable customer-engagement and account-management processes covering follow-up, issue resolution, retention interventions, and revenue opportunities; reinforced consistent execution across international markets.
- Used customer signals, account performance, and direct feedback to prioritize retention and expansion actions; coordinated commercial, operational, and product-management workstreams to improve customer outcomes and execution.
- Expanded the business from Dubai into Saudi Arabia, creating rollout plans and repeatable operating practices while navigating ambiguity, cross-functional priorities, and executive-level stakeholder relationships.

Color Maple Ltd. - Business Development Manager | May 2016 - May 2017

Hong Kong | Dubai, UAE

- Identified execution bottlenecks and redesigned customer and operating workflows to improve responsiveness, consistency, and delivery across fast-moving international operations.

SELECTED ANALYTICS, AI & FINTECH PROJECTS

AI Bookkeeping & Finance Automation Agent: Built a workflow that interprets and classifies transactions, applies business rules, automates recurring finance tasks, and routes exceptions for structured human review.

AI Workflow Automation & MCP: Built multi-step workflows using n8n, Model Context Protocol (MCP), REST APIs, prompt engineering, and tool calling to automate operational processes and connect systems.

EDUCATION

M.S. in Business Analytics - Mercer University, Atlanta, GA | Expected Dec 2026

Relevant study: Descriptive, Predictive & Prescriptive Analytics; Applied Data Mining & Machine Learning; Advanced Statistics; Financial Analytics & Optimization

Bachelor of Management Studies - H.R. College of Commerce & Economics, Mumbai, India

CUSTOMER SUCCESS, GROWTH & ANALYTICAL SKILLS

Customer Success & Growth: Book of Business Management, Gross Dollar Retention (GDR), Customer Retention, Churn Risk, Adoption, Implementation, Expansion, Upsell & Cross-Sell, High-Volume Outreach, Customer Engagement, Account Growth, Playbook Development, Segmentation, Experimentation, Customer Feedback, Revenue Growth

Operations & Leadership: Cross-Functional Collaboration, Team Training & Enablement, Executive Stakeholder Management, Process Design, Workflow Improvement, KPI Tracking, Operational Efficiency, Ambiguity Management

Analytics & Technology: Excel, Google Sheets, SQL, Python, R, Power BI, Tableau, Machine Learning, n8n, MCP, REST APIs, Agentic AI, RAG, pandas, NumPy, PySpark, Jupyter